heat stroke

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Summary

On rare occasions, Kephale's unyielding dawn casts an intense blanket of heat over the city of Okhema.

It's on such a day that Phainon and Mydei find themselves partaking in a routine sparring session in the midst of a brutal heat wave.

The issue?

Phainon just can't seem to keep his eyes - nor his hands - to himself, especially after he glimpses a wreath of flowers in Mydei's possession. Because a flower wreath is a sign of courting, a sign that someone is attempting to court *the* Crown Prince of Kremnos.

And that someone is *not* him.

Notes

live, laugh, love phaidei *inserts elmo fire meme here*

See the end of the work for more notes

Phainon looks.

He looks, but he does not touch. Cannot touch, is more like it. To touch would be to unravel all of the years of carefully crafted composure, to muddy lines drawn in sand. Even so, he desperately *wants* to touch; even if it's selfish, even if he knows to do so would ruin this delicate thing that they have.

But *Kephale help him*, Mydeimos looks incredible like this, freshly flushed from their spar, muscles rippling as he shifts and crosses his arms over his chest—

"Something on your mind, Deliverer?"

Mydei's gravelly timbre shatters his thoughts. Phainon blinks, straightens and tears his eyes from the glistening plane of the Kremnoan's chest, crimson tattoos framing the fine-cut lines of his abdomen. The eternal dawn seems to burn a bit brighter this afternoon, a bit hotter, and Phainon reaches up to brush silver bangs from his sweat-slicked brow.

"You're not usually one to bring up such things?" He arches a brow playfully, question poised in the form of an observation.

"Hmph. Forget I asked."

Ah, so that's as far as Mydei will go to entertain his teasing, he supposes.

Phainon's grip on his blade slackens and he rests it against the bench with the rest of his and Mydei's belongings. Bottles of water, athletic wrappings, and — most curiously — a wreath of flowers, similar to those that blossom within Okhema's gardens, are scattered atop the bench.

Oh.

Phainon jerks his chin, uncaps his water in an effort to slake the thirst that has him parched beneath the unyielding dawn. The dry patch on his tongue is due to the heat, of course. Nothing else.

“What a pretty bundle of flowers. Did Tribbie make that for you?”

Mydei’s fingers pause, hovering over his jug of water. Phainon watches as thoughts he’s not privy to flit behind amber eyes, cocks his head in intrigue. Mydeimos has always been a man of few words, but he is exceptionally quiet today.

Mydei’s gaze follows his, settles on the delicate wreath woven of fresh blossoms. He clears his throat and throws his head back to take a generous swig of water, bronze knuckles glinting in the sunlight. Phainon tries to keep his eyes from lingering on the way the other’s adam’s apple bobs, the way the crimson tips of his mane of hair threaten to stick to the nape of his neck.

“It’s nothing you need concern yourself with, Deliverer.”

“O, Crown Prince of Kremnos, are we not friends?”

Phainon jabs his side with an elbow, desperate to quell the uncomfortable tension prickling at the base of his spine. If he doesn’t move, then that unease will spread, will bubble beneath his skin until it becomes nigh unbearable.

“If I didn’t know any better, I’d say that that came from one of Okhema’s eligible young bachelorettes.”

Mydei is, once again, silent, and Phainon feels his heart drop into his stomach, nearly fumbles the water jug in his grasp. It would seem that his suspicions are correct, that it was *not* Tribios who’d gifted him such a thing.

Phainon searches for something to say, something that will soothe the sour notes that cling to the back of his tongue as he clears his throat. Perhaps Mydei notices, maybe even feels a little bad, because those eyes of amber warm to something more honeyed as he gives a shrug.

“It was…a gift. I’d meant to rid myself of it before our session.”

Warmth floods Phainon's cheeks. He runs a palm over his face, deciding that — should Mydei comment on the color that spreads over his features — he'll blame it on the midday heat. Phainon might have branded himself a pining fool long ago, but he doesn't need Mydei suspecting such a thing, let alone echoing the sentiment.

"Dashing the hopes of Okhema's doting suitors? How crass of you."

Phainon ignores the bitter aftertaste such words leave in his mouth, sour on his tongue. It's a bit naive, to hope that such a thing has gone unnoticed by the other, and a peek from beneath dark lashes only confirms his suspicions as the other stills.

Mydei gives a click of his tongue, amber eyes flickering from the bottle in his grasp to his face. Phainon swallows beneath the weight of his gaze, maintains that steady smile and relaxed shoulders, even if his pulse is thundering in his ears and something in his gut squirms.

He needs to act. To move, to do something, *anything*. Anything to relieve the sudden, strange quiet that's suffocating the pair of them, the only sound amidst the stifling humidity the breeze as it cards through his hair. Mydei makes no move to re-enter the sparring ring, though, and Phainon sighs and busies himself with his coat.

If Mydei refuses to diffuse the tension, then it's his duty to at least try.

Phainon shirks his outer layers, hooks his fingers beneath the lightweight material of his undershirt. He tugs it over his head with little finesse, struggles with the collar as it catches on his jaw.

A reedy groan of frustration flits between his teeth, and he debates tearing the damnable thing in two in embarrassment as he shuffles to the ring's entrance, gravel loose beneath his feet.

An armored hand settles atop his own — each nimble, calloused finger clad in bronze and honed to a dangerous point — and slips beneath his shirt, aids him in tugging it free from where it catches on his chin. Phainon shudders at the faintest brush of metal against his skin, flushes as he realizes that

Mydei's born witness to his awkward shuffle-dance around the sparring ring whilst trapped in his clothes.

"Ah, t-thank you, my friend."

Mydei waves off his chipper tone, turns on his heel before Phainon can make out his features. If he didn't know any better, he'd think he'd glimpsed a tinge of pink lingering in the tips of the Kremnoan prince's ears. But that's just not possible, and he turns his attentions elsewhere, hangs his shirt over the rail of the ring.

A sigh of relief dangles on his tongue at the breeze that ruffles his hair, silver waves settling over his brow. It's far cooler like this, wind kissing his bare skin and soothing some of that feverish ache. He dares a glance over at his sparring partner, misses the way Mydei wrenches his eyes from his bare torso as though he's been caught doing something he shouldn't.

Unsurprisingly, Mydei refuses to shed so much as an article of clothing, nor a plate of armor. As expected, Phainon thinks with a crooked grin. He's practically half naked as is, after all, what with his magnificent build exposed.

Phainon cards a hand through his hair, flexes his fingers, jumps up and down in an effort to get his blood pumping once more. Not that he really needs it, not with Mydei's body on display and that abhorrent sense of irritation still prickling at the ends of his nerves.

A flower crown for Mydeimos, the Undying? Why hadn't he ever thought of such a thing.

"Calling it quits for the day already?" Phainon teases.

"Hardly."

Mydei's gaze flickers to the wreath of flowers atop the bench as he speaks, expression indecipherable. He brings his bottle of water to his lips and swallows it down until it's empty. Phainon waits patiently at the ring's

entrance, stretches his limbs and reaches his arms to the sky before his spine yields with a satisfying *pop!*

“You’re really going to keep all of your layers on? Don’t tell me that you *don’t* find it exceptionally warm out today.”

“It’s hardly as severe as you make it out to be, Deliverer.” Mydei scoffs. “Kremnoans’ bath water was never any less than boiling, a mere babe could endure heat greater than this.”

Phainon arches a brow with a shake of his head, eyes glinting. Sometimes, he wonders if Mydei is serious. He’s a man of his word, of course, but there are only so many tall tales he can take before he calls such claims into question, and his fingers dance over the gilded sun buckle of his belt, centering it.

“Is that so? What remarkable fortitude you and your people have.” The tension that draws his shoulders taut dissipates the moment Mydei enters the ring, fire sparkling in those amber eyes. “I should’ve known better than to question it.”

“Indeed.” Mydei hums, amusement coloring his tone.

Phainon finds it easy to slip into their usual back and forth like this, flowers forgotten. Within the ring, only he and Mydei exist, and it’s as they situate themselves and tense, muscles coiled in wait for the other to pounce, that Phainon’s gaze drifts from the focused look on Mydei’s face to his torso.

Those carefully honed muscles tense, ripple, shining beneath a sheen of sweat, and the dry patch on his tongue returns tenfold. Because someone *else* is attempting to court the Crown Prince of Kremnos, someone is trying to snatch him away. And that someone is not *him.*

Mydei lunges. Phainon knows to expect it, after so many years spent training with each other, challenging one another. Mydei always pounces first, and Phainon moves to counter it, a delicate dance atop the shifting gravel of the ring.

He catches Mydei’s outstretched wrist in a vice grip, shifts and counters, wind ruffling his hair as they switch places. Intrusive thoughts cleave through his conscience, threaten to spoil whatever offensive plans he might’ve had.

Phainon - like a lovesick fool - wonders what the pretty maiden looked like, wonders if Mydei was polite in his acceptance of her gift, if he made her smile. If *he* smiled back; Mydei is always careful with his smiles. He spares them like they're finite, precious things, and Phainon grits his teeth in frustration.

Because they *are* precious things, at least to him.

Bronze-clad fingers quiver and tense beneath his hold before he releases the other’s wrist, and that frustration returns, bubbles in his belly, has azure eyes glinting, ice cold. Mydei huffs, brows furrowed, and the blond roots of his hair gleam gold against the backdrop of Kephale’s dawn.

“What’s got you so worked up today? Something’s bothering you, Deliverer.”

Phainon’s breath catches, sweat gathering along his brow.

“It’s nothing. Are you so concerned that I’ll emerge victorious that you’ve opted for mind games this round?” Phainon forces a teasing tone to his voice, clears his throat.

He’s fine, they’re *fine.* After all, a wreath of flowers is nothing more than a customary, initial sign of attempted courting. And Mydei had said himself that he’d intended to rid himself of it, like he wasn’t all that interested in the first place.

Then why does Phainon feel like his insides are on fire?

Mydei lunges a second time, and Phainon’s heels skate over gravel as he rides the breeze and retreats a step, just out of reach. Clawed fingertips graze the tips of silver hair, and an airy chuckle flits between Phainon’s

teeth. He watches as an edge of frustration sharpens Mydei's features, amber eyes alight.

There's a moment of weakness where eyes of brilliant blue flicker from the Kremnoan in front of him back to the bench, to the buds and blossoms knotted together. It's a fool's error, Phainon thinks, and that agitation prickles at the base of his spine as his lips purse.

"Oh?" Mydei's voice rings out, a victorious symphony as the ghost of a grin graces his features. "I didn't realize a mere flower wreath would have you so undone."

Phainon halts at that, blinks with wide eyes. The dawn is suddenly too hot, too blindingly bright, silver hair caught in his lashes. He side steps a heartbeat too late, fingers wrapping about his wrists as the earth disappears from beneath his feet.

He falters, stumbling along the uneven gravel and landing on his back with a yelp of surprise. There's something warm and weighty above him, pinning him down, and Phainon blinks back the brilliant dawn, Mydei silhouetted against it. His gaze drifts over those fine features, a huff punched from his gut. Fine hairs tickle his cheeks as Mydei looms over him, wrists caught in his hands and pinned above him.

"Do you yield?"

Phainon swallows, alarmingly aware of every brush, every touch. "That's no fair— "

"That's not what I asked." Mydei's clawed fingertips dip pointedly into the flesh of Phainon's wrists, bronze warmed through by the sun. "Do you yield?"

That crafted dam of control bursts painfully easy. Phainon's cheeks blaze and his lips part, a brilliant shade of scarlet tinging his features, and Mydei shifts atop him. He rests against the cradle of his hips, leans in dangerously close.

It’s all a part of the thrill of the fight, Phainon thinks, forcing his eyes up and away from the stuttering, sweat-slicked plane of his chest. That’s all this is. That’s what has Mydei panting, has him dipping in close, breath fanning over his features.

Pomegranates, Phainon notes, Mydei smells like pomegranates. His nostrils flare and something in his abdomen winds him tight, has his composure teetering on an edge. Because Mydei is flushed pink and the swell of his chest rises and falls with every breath, fine-cut muscles of his abdomen rippling.

“I’ve won. Why are you set on denying me my victory when I’ve so clearly achieved it?”

Mydei releases his wrists, leans back out of his space, and *please, don’t go, not yet—*

Phainon’s hands settle on his hips before he can think. They flutter over his waistband, a horrible, selfish action rooted in subconscious desires that have long been stamped down.

“I-I — ” Phainon’s words die in his throat, and Mydei regards him with a look that’s equal parts shock and intrigue. “I wouldn’t qualify this as a victory. You haven’t won fairly.”

What in the Titan’s name is he doing?

Phainon isn’t sure, but there’s a glint to Mydei’s gaze that he hasn’t seen before. Something warm and honeyed simmers beneath amber, sets his eyes ablaze. The weight in his lap grows a bit heavier, almost as if Mydei’s relaxed against him, and a pressure bubbles in his belly at the fact that they’re close, that they’re mere inches away from brushing against each other beneath damp clothes and plates of armor.

“Is that so?” Mydei’s voice thins, albeit minutely. “Please, enlighten me. Explain to me how I’ve not won this round?”

Mydei's…teasing? Maybe. Phainon blinks back the brilliant light of dawn as sweat gathers at his nape, beads along his forehead. Mydei's torso glistens tantalizingly in the midday sun, crimson ink twinkling with every rise and fall of his chest in the blistering heat.

"Are you…you're toying with me, are you not, Mydeimos?"

To say that Phainon is incredulous would be an understatement, and he watches as blond brows pinch over Mydei's nose at his response. He shifts atop him, does nothing to bat away the warm palms that squeeze his hips gently, anchoring him in place.

"I could tell something was awry the moment you spotted those flowers." Mydei's voice comes out a bit broken, a bit bitter, and Phainon swallows at such a rare display of vulnerability. "But you refused to speak on it."

Once again, Phainon can only stutter. "W-Well, I— "

"How long, Deliverer?"

"What?"

Mydei's eyes warm, embers beneath dark lashes, and he seats himself properly in Phainon's lap until the latter looses a gasp.

"This." Bronze-tipped fingers settle atop Phainon's, urges them to dig a bit deeper into his hips as a shameful flush creeps over Mydei's features. "How long has this been going on for?"

There's a moment where Phainon considers that perhaps the heat has gotten to him. This is all clearly some kind of feverish fantasy, yes? That explains the near-sheepish expression Mydei regards him with, at the very least. But the heat of him in his lap is scalding, the weight of him full and grounded.

Phainon blinks, swallows as he reclines uncomfortably against the gravel, stones biting into his bare shoulder blades.

"I'm sorry, I don't — "

Mydei's lips are on his before he can finish.

Phainon's eyes blow wide in surprise, desire coursing through his veins and thrumming pleasantly in his extremities. He's supposed to close his eyes, he thinks. That's what most people do when they're kissed, right?

But Mydei's are also owlishly wide, and he regards him with a look of curiosity. Like he's just as shocked by his actions, lips warm and slotted against his own. Phainon marks the way the tension ebbs from his hands, his shoulders, the Kremnoan relaxing into his hold. Amber eyes finally flutter shut, dark lashes knit together, and Phainon follows suit.

Mydei leans into him, soft and sweet and needy.

What a remarkable contrast to his usual attitude, Phainon nearly chuckles. Instead, his grip on his hips tightens, and he draws Mydei impossibly closer, the air hot and heady.

He's fantasized about kissing him before, of course. But Phainon's never *actually* kissed anyone, and to have Mydei be his first? A groan slips past his lips, and Mydei swallows it down greedily, stifles a whine.

Mydeimos kisses the same way he fights; aggressive, all-consuming, desperately chasing after victory, if there's even such a thing to be had in a moment like this. Phainon rises to meet him, threads his fingers in his hair, tugs until Mydei is scrabbling at gravel to keep himself upright in his lap, a shameless whimper on his tongue.

Arousal pulses wickedly low in his belly, a divine pressure that has Phainon desperate to buck up against the weight in his lap. He stifles another groan as his pulse thunders in his ears, thrums in his groin.

Mydei breaks away first with a sigh, chest heaving. Phainon expects him to stand, to push him away and retreat with his tail tucked between his legs, his victory foiled. It's quite the surprise when those pupils blow wide, settling on his face, drinking in his flushed features.

Mydei breaks the silence, a shuddering breath wracking his frame.

“I…It’s been the same for me, too, you know. For a long while.”

“But the flowers—”

“— didn’t mean that I reciprocated in any capacity.” Mydei bites back a sigh as something hard pokes the underside of this thigh, desire sparking at the base of his spine. “I’d intended to give them to Tribbie as a harmless gift before this. I ran out of time.”

Phainon forces his hips against the gravel, ignores the sting as stones press into his skin. There’s a tent in his pants, cock throbbing, and heat courses through him as shame colors the tips of his ears. Mydei doesn’t seem to mind, brings their hips flush together, and Phainon’s fingers flutter from his hips to his waist in an effort to push him away, embarrassed.

“M-Mydei, *wait—*“

Those lips are on his again, hungry and desperate. He tries to maintain a level head, he really does, but to have Mydeimos so eager in his lap has any constraints undone. The Kremnoan grinds against him, a subconscious swivel of his hips that has him seeing stars, and Phainon gasps and breaks away to nose at Mydei’s jaw, the fine column of his throat.

When Phainon moves to his chest, Mydei makes no move to stop him. He voices no objections as lips brush over his skin, scalding to the touch and sweat-soaked. Phainon blinks up at him, marks the way Mydei’s lips part and his head falls back as he nips along his chest, teases around a nipple.

“Deliverer.”

Mydei must enjoy that, then. The corners of his lips twitch, and Phainon bites, the blunt line of his teeth sinking into skin. Mydei groans, hips bucking of their own accord, a jolt of arousal going straight to his dick.

Mydei tastes like salt, like victory, like *need.* Phainon litters his chest with bruises, catches a nipple between his lips and sucks, sees what delightful sounds he can wring from the other. Mydei is, remarkably, much louder than he’d anticipated. A whine catches in his throat as his hips begin to

move in earnest, desperate, pointed grinds that drive him against the bulge in Phainon's pants.

Mydei rocks his ass against the cradle of Phainon's hips, rides him with shuddering, broken breaths. Every brush sends sparks skittering throughout Phainon's body, has him arching against the gravel in pleasure as he nips along the line of a crimson tattoo.

All too quickly, that pressure halts. Mydei's brows pinch over his nose, and he watches Phainon squirm beneath him in frustration at the sudden lack of friction.

Mydei waits. He waits for Phainon to move, to grind, to pull him down against him. He sucks a lip between his teeth in want, tears his gaze away as pink deepens in his cheeks, spreads down the ample swell of his chest. Phainon's fingers dig into his waist, a bruising hold, and he stares up at the other with a look of arousal and curiosity.

If Mydei wants more, he doesn't dignify such a desire with a verbal request. But Phainon notices, notes the way amber eyes flicker about the ring to ensure that they're still alone, the way that his hips stutter as he shifts beneath him.

"Giving up on me already?" Phainon teases, breathless. "Aren't you meant to be obsessed with victory?"

That stokes the embers that pulse low in Mydei's belly, sparks them to a flame. Phainon gasps, groans as armored fingers splay out over his chest, teasing his nipples. Mydei's composure finally seems to snap, and those hips drive against his with an unrelenting dedication.

Mydei chases after the aching bulge in his pants like he's desperate, like he craves something inside, something to stretch him and fill him. Phainon nearly shudders in relief, hips bucking up to meet every grind, a whine caught in his throat at the thought of slipping into that tight, wanton heat.

It seems that they're compatible in *that* department, at the very least.

His cock rubs directly against Phainon’s, wrings a shiver. Amber eyes flutter shut, Mydei’s grinds grows more fervent, a feverish heat building in the cavity of Phainon’s chest. Mydei must be close, what with the whines that slip past his lips and the way his fingers tremble where they splay out over his bare chest in an effort to keep himself upright.

Phainon cradles his hips, grip dangerously tight, and he bucks up and meets every desperate thrust until Mydei is quivering beneath his touch.

“M-Mydei.”

Mydei groans, tips of his armor dipping into Phainon’s skin.

“Mydeimos.”

His eyes flicker open at that, at the way Phainon pants his name so sweetly. Fingers trail up the curve of his waist, the swell of his chest, and Phainon cups his face as that pleasure builds, threatening to crest.

One hand anchors him in place as the other swipes a thumb over Mydei’s jaw, delights in the way the Kremnoan chases after such a fleeting touch. Phainon can see it, the way he dangles on the precipice, hips stuttering beneath his palm. He ruts against him, eager to see Mydeimos undone, desperate for it.

He gives another grind, a gasp caught in his throat. It has Phainon’s cock throbbing in his pants, enough to earn a breathy sigh, and he watches in delight as Mydei’s hips stutter and the bulge in his trousers twitches.

Mydei looses a cry, climax shuddering through him, and Phainon watches with parted lips as a tear carves its way down his cheek. He’s *beautiful* when he cries, Phainon decides, and that thought goes straight to his dick.

Mydei rides him, rides out his orgasm with lazy grinds and pitiful whimpers, brows knit together and amber gaze half-lidded. Cum soils his pants, leaves them wet and sticky, and it does little to slow the rhythm of his hips.

Phainon swallows, fists at his hair with trembling fingers. Because Mydei begins to grind against him with a vengeance, his own hunger sated, and Phainon's release is his next goal.

Every thrust against his full, aching member has his heels digging into the gravel, a burst of sparks that travels to the tips of his fingers, his toes.

Phainon pleads, that coil winding painfully tight. "M-Mydei— "

"Relax, Deliverer." That gravelly tone rumbles in his ear, and Phainon bites back a groan as his grip on his hips tightens.

A hand dips hastily between his thighs, the sound of his buckle coming undone ringing in his ears. Mydei's hand is cool against his undergarments, bronze a mild warmth compared to the scalding heat of him. Phainon gasps, throws his head back until the pebbles bite against his scalp.

Mydei makes quick work of him. He glides his fist along his aching length through the fabric, thumbs at the wet spot that soils the cotton. He pumps him until Phainon is thrashing beneath him, fingers trailing up the broad, glittering expanse of his chest to tease his pert nipples.

"So, Deliverer?" Mydei taunts, gives an especially pointed tug that has the other writhing beneath him. "Will you yield?"

When Phainon blinks, he sees stars. When he breathes, he inhales the scent of rust and pomegranate and spice, a wonderful symphony that clings to Mydei's skin. The Kremnoan gives another tug, squeezes beneath the head of his cock until precum beads and bleeds through his undergarments.

Phainon's hips buck up once, twice into that waiting hand, and he bites his lower lip until the tang of copper coats his tongue.

"I-I yield."

Mydei's lips are on his, fierce and demanding, even as a whine winds up his throat and Phainon swallows it down. He fucks into Mydei's waiting hand, gasps for air as pleasure burns through him.

That dam in his belly bursts, greedy hunger satiated, and Mydei pumps him through his orgasm until he's wrung dry. A myriad of colors burst behind closed eyelids as Mydei's hand slips up the limp length of him, tips of his armored fingers catching the tip. There's not a drop left to give, his undergarments soiled, and Mydei releases his flagging length with a sigh and licks into his mouth.

Phainon groans as his belt is buckled, pants soiled and tacky against his abdomen.

There's a moment of silence, the humid, heavy air settling thickly about them. Mydei swipes his forearm along his brow, panting in the aftermath. Kephale's dawn still beats down relentlessly, and Phainon groans as he props himself up onto his forearms.

"…Well, that was *certainly* interesting."

"Shut up." Mydei huffs, rolls his eyes, and color gathers in the tips of his ears.

Phainon grins like he's won their spar, like he hadn't admitted defeat mere moments before. "What, you didn't enjoy that?"

Mydei's lips are on his again, a gentle pressure. He tastes sweet, like honeydew and pomegranate, like spring. Phainon hums, relaxes into him, and a pair of hands hoist him upright as Mydei slips from his lap and stands.

He breaks away, lips pursed. Phainon's twitch at the sight of the Crown Prince of Kremnos so undone, and he noses along his jaw as his pants stick to his belly, an unpleasant reminder of their tryst.

"Care to join me for a bath, Mydeimos?"

Mydei grunts, folds his arms over his chest. But he leans into Phainon's touch regardless, pink gathering in the swell of his cheeks.

"I…suppose a bath would be nice."

“You know, I think it’s fair to say that *I* won this round.”

Mydei frowns as Phainon strides to the exit of the ring, a crooked grin tacked onto his features. He shakes his head, heaves a sigh and ignores the way Phainon’s words settle warmly in his belly.

“There’s always next time, Deliverer.”

“Mhm. That, there is.”

End Notes

is it gay if the armor stays on, fellas?

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